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Amazon DynamoDB

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Developer Guide

Cheat sheet for DynamoDB

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(</pdfs/amazondynamodb/latest/developerguide/dynamodb-dg.pdf#CheatSheet>)

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(<dynamodbupdates.rss>)

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Amazon DynamoDB API Reference

(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/amazondynamodb/latest/APIReference/index.html>)

Cheat Sheet

(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/amazondynamodb/latest/developerguide/CheatSheet.html>)

Using Amazon DynamoDB with an AWS SDK

(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/amazondynamodb/latest/developerguide/sdk-general>)

Recommended tasks

Learn about

Understand core components and data organization in DynamoDB

(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/amazondynamodb/latest/developerguide/HowItWorks.CoreComponents.html>)

Understand the DynamoDB API operations and their use cases

(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/amazondynamodb/latest/developerguide/HowItWorks.API.html>)

Understand what Amazon DynamoDB is

(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/amazondynamodb/latest/developerguide/Introduction.html>)

Understand supported data types and naming rules in DynamoDB

(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/amazondynamodb/latest/developerguide/HowItWorks.NamingRulesDataTypes.html>)

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This cheat sheet provides a quick reference for working with Amazon DynamoDB and its various AWS SDKs.

Initial setup

1. [Sign up for AWS \(SettingUp.DynamoWebService.html#SettingUp.DynamoWebService.SignUpForAWS\)](#) .
2. [Get an AWS access key \(SettingUp.DynamoWebService.html#SettingUp.DynamoWebService.GetCredentials\)](#) to programmatically.
3. [Configure your DynamoDB credentials \(SettingUp.DynamoWebService.html#SettingUp.DynamoWebService.C](#)

See also:

- [Setting up DynamoDB \(web service\) \(SettingUp.DynamoWebService.html\)](#)
- [Getting started with DynamoDB \(GettingStartedDynamoDB.html\)](#)
- [Basic overview of core components \(HowItWorks.CoreComponents.html\)](#)

SDK or CLI

Choose your preferred [SDK \(sdk-general-information-section.html\)](#) , or set up the [AWS CLI \(/cli/latest/index.html\)](#)

Note

When you use the AWS CLI on Windows, a backslash (\) that is not inside a quote is treated as a carriage return. You must escape any quotes and braces inside other quotes. For an example, see the **Windows** tab in the next section.

See also:

- [AWS CLI with DynamoDB \(Tools.CLI.html\)](#)
- [Getting started with DynamoDB - step 2 \(getting-started-step-2.html\)](#)

Basic actions

This section provides code for basic DynamoDB tasks. For more information about these tasks, see [Getting started with DynamoDB and the AWS SDKs \(GettingStarted.html\)](#) .

Create a table

DefaultWindows

```
aws dynamodb create-table \
  --table-name Music \
  --attribute-definitions \
    AttributeName=Artist,AttributeType=S \
    AttributeName=SongTitle,AttributeType=S \
  --key-schema AttributeName=Artist,KeyType=HASH \
    AttributeName=SongTitle,KeyType=RANGE \
  --billing-mode PAY_PER_REQUEST \
  --table-class STANDARD
```

Write item to a table

```
aws dynamodb put-item \ --table-name Music \ --item file://item.json
```

Read item from a table

```
aws dynamodb get-item \ --table-name Music \ --item file://item.json
```

Delete item from a table

```
aws dynamodb delete-item --table-name Music --key file://key.json
```

Query a table

```
aws dynamodb query --table-name Music  
--key-condition-expression "ArtistName=:Artist and SongName=:Songtitle"
```

Delete a table

```
aws dynamodb delete-table --table-name Music
```

List table names

```
aws dynamodb list-tables
```

Naming rules

- All names must be encoded using UTF-8 and are case sensitive.
- Table names and index names must be between 3 and 255 characters long, and can contain only the following characters:
 - a-z
 - A-Z
 - 0-9
 - _ (underscore)
 - - (hyphen)
 - . (dot)
- Attribute names must be at least one character long, and less than 64 KB in size.

For more information, see [Naming rules \(HowItWorks.NamingRulesDataTypes.html\)](#) .

Service quota basics

Read and write units

- **Read capacity unit (RCU)** – One strongly consistent read per second, or two eventually consistent read items up to 4 KB in size.
- **Write capacity unit (WCU)** – One write per second, for items up to 1 KB in size.

Table limits

- **Table size** – There is no practical limit on table size. Tables are unconstrained in terms of the number of bytes.

- **Number of tables** – For any AWS account, there is an initial quota of 2,500 tables per AWS Region.
- **Page size limit for query and scan** – There is a limit of 1 MB per page, per query or scan. If your query operation on a table result in more than 1 MB of data, DynamoDB returns the initial matching items. It LastEvaluatedKey property that you can use in a new request to read the next page.

Indexes

- **Local secondary indexes (LSIs)** – You can define a maximum of five local secondary indexes. LSIs are p an index must have strong consistency with the base table.
- **Global secondary indexes (GSIs)** – There is a default quota of 20 global secondary indexes per table.
- **Projected secondary index attributes per table** – You can project a total of up to 100 attributes into a and global secondary indexes. This only applies to user-specified projected attributes.

Partition keys

- The minimum length of a partition key value is 1 byte. The maximum length is 2048 bytes.
- There is no practical limit on the number of distinct partition key values, for tables or for secondary inc
- The minimum length of a sort key value is 1 byte. The maximum length is 1024 bytes.
- In general, there is no practical limit on the number of distinct sort key values per partition key value. 1 tables with secondary indexes.

For more information on secondary indexes, partition key design, and sort key design, see [Best practices \(be](#)

Limits for commonly used data types

- **String** – The length of a string is constrained by the maximum item size of 400 KB. Strings are Unicode encoding.
- **Number** – A number can have up to 38 digits of precision, and can be positive, negative, or zero.
- **Binary** – The length of a binary is constrained by the maximum item size of 400 KB. Applications that v attributes must encode the data in base64 encoding before sending it to DynamoDB.

For a full list of supported data types, see [Data types \(HowItWorks.NamingRulesDataTypes.html#HowItWorks.Da](#) information, also see [Service quotas \(ServiceQuotas.html#limits-items\)](#) .

Items, attributes, and expression parameters

The maximum item size in DynamoDB is 400 KB, which includes both attribute name binary length (UTF-8 value binary lengths (UTF-8 length). The attribute name counts towards the size limit.

There is no limit on the number of values in a list, map, or set, as long as the item that contains the values i KB item size limit.

For expression parameters, the maximum length of any expression string is 4 KB.

For more information about item size, attributes, and expression parameters, see [Service quotas \(ServiceQu](#)

More information

- [Security \(security.html\)](#)
- [Monitoring and logging \(monitoring.html\)](#)
- [Working with streams \(streamsmain.html\)](#)
- [Backups \(Backup-and-Restore.html\)](#) and [Point-in-time recovery \(Point-in-time-recovery.html\)](#)
- [Integrating with other AWS services \(OtherServices.html\)](#)
- [API reference \(/amazondynamodb/latest/APIReference/Welcome.html\)](#)
- [Architecture Center: Database Best Practices [↗] \(https://aws.amazon.com/architecture/databases/\)](#)
- [Video tutorials [↗] \(https://youtu.be/Mw8wCj0gkRc\)](#)
- [DynamoDB forum [↗] \(https://repost.aws/search/questions?globalSearch=dynamodb\)](#)

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(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/decision-guides/>)

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- Choosing a generative AI service
(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/generative-ai-on-aws-how-to-choose/>)
- AWS service guides
(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/#products>)
- AWS CLI Tutorials on GitHub 
(<https://github.com/aws-samples/sample-developer-tutorials>)

Developer Tools

- AWS Code Example Library
(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/code-library/latest/ug/what-is-code-library.html>)
- AWS CLI
(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/cli/>)
- AWS Builder Center 
(<https://builder.aws.com/>)
- AWS Developer Tools Blog 
(<https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/developer/>)

Helpful Links

- Download the AWS Docs MCP Server 
(<https://github.com/awslabs/mcp/tree/main/src/aws-documentation-mcp-server>)
- Sign into the AWS Console 
(<https://console.aws.amazon.com/>)
- AWS re:Post 
(<https://repost.aws/>)

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